higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

# NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

## OFFICE PRACTICE
### NQF LEVEL 3

(3061013)

**26 November 2019 (X-Paper)**
**09:00–12:00**

**This question paper consists of 11 pages and 4 addenda.**

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**TIME: 3 HOURS**
**MARKS: 200**

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**INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION**

1. Answer ALL the questions.
2. Read ALL the questions carefully.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Start each section on a NEW page.
5. Use only BLUE or BLACK ink.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

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## SECTION A

## QUESTION 1

1.1 Various options are given as possible answers to the following questions. Choose the correct answer and write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.15) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 The petty cashier determines the mix of notes and coins required from the …

A purchasing department.
B finance department.
C production department.
D procurement department.

1.1.2 A system that works in combination with numerical and alpha-numerical classifications to help with the retrieval of documents:

A Colour coding
B Index cards
C Out register
D Tracking

1.1.3 To help you select a caterer for an event, they should provide you with a(n) …

A programme.
B agenda.
C deposit.
D quotation.

1.1.4 When ordering supplies, the total value of a stock item is calculated by …

A adding the quantity to the unit price.
B subtracting the quantity from the unit price.
C multiplying the quantity with the unit price.
D dividing the unit price by the quantity.

1.1.5 Which of the following appointments has not been confirmed?

A An appointment written in pen
B An appointment with a line drawn through it
C An appointment written in pencil
D An appointment with a tick next to it

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1.1.6 An item that is not a petty cash source document:

A Requisition form
B Petty cash voucher
C Cheque
D Receipt

1.1.7 Implementing a queuing system means to …

A display signage.
B clear obstructions.
C attend to visitors in the order of their arrival.
D make eye contact with visitors.

1.1.8 A sheet or document used to plan one's activities for the year ahead is called a … planner.

A yearly
B monthly
C weekly
D daily

1.1.9 When a caller is rude and disrespectful, the switchboard operator must display …

A aggression.
B impatience.
C temper.
D assertiveness.

1.1.10 Petty cash will be stored here for safekeeping:

A Drawer
B Filing cabinet
C Ziploc bag
D Cash box

1.1.11 This indicator will tell a supplies clerk how much stock is on hand:

A Maximum level
B Re-order level
C Balance
D Re-order quantity

1.1.12 Asking a caller for the reason for their call is referred to as …

A transferring calls.
B screening calls.
C taking a message.
D redirecting a call.

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1.1.13 The best method to confirm changes to a meeting that involves a large number of stakeholders is by …

A telephone.
B e-mail.
C fax.
D notice.

1.1.14 In order to cater for the needs of all attendees, they must complete this document:

A Visa
B Enquiry form
C Invitation
D Diary

1.1.15 A/an … is an instant form of communication and the receiver will have a hard copy of the message.

A e-mail
B fax
C letter
D memorandum

(15 × 1) (15)

1.2 ALL of the following statements are FALSE. Correct the underlined words/phrases to make the statements TRUE. Write only the correct word or phrase next to the question number (1.2.1–1.2.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.2.1 When there is no analysis column to record a transaction, the entry must be recorded in the wages column.

1.2.2 The event organiser will provide the contributors with a time by which to submit their notes.

1.2.3 A cancelled appointment will take place at a later time.

1.2.4 Managers may visit the reception area and enquire how visitors are being treated.

1.2.5 A weekly planner will be used to plan the year ahead.

1.2.6 Petty cash vouchers are filed in chronological order.

1.2.7 An electronic diary will reflect both the appointments of the manager and those of the personal assistant.

1.2.8 'Structural needs' refers to the requirements a company has to be able to run efficiently.

1.2.9 Legible diary entries will assist in creating misunderstandings.

1.2.10 Being aggressive implies that you politely refuse to do something inappropriate.

(10 × 2) (20)

1.3 Choose a term from COLUMN B that matches a description in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–P) next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.15) in the ANSWER BOOK.

| COLUMN A | | COLUMN B | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1.3.1 | An emergency telephone number that must be prominently displayed | A | rotation |
| 1.3.2 | An action that can improve customer satisfaction | B | yellow pages |
| 1.3.3 | Dietary requirements of an attendee at an event | C | calendar |
| 1.3.4 | The maximum amount of money that will be in the petty cash box | D | receptionist |
| 1.3.5 | A method used in the control of office supplies | E | bomb disposal squad |
| 1.3.6 | The location of this security measure should be near the front entrance of a building | F | geographical |
| 1.3.7 | A facility found in a diary | G | cross-referencing |
| 1.3.8 | Files are arranged according to areas or towns | H | mentor |
| 1.3.9 | The directory that gives the contact details and other information of businesses | I | milk |
| 1.3.10 | Person responsible for ensuring the maintenance of the reception area | J | imprest |
| 1.3.11 | This is important when speaking with callers on the telephone | K | diary |
| 1.3.12 | The staff member who acts as a coach to the receptionist | L | gun safe |
| 1.3.13 | Manual filing procedure | M | archives |
| 1.3.14 | An item that can be purchased from petty cash | N | posture |
| 1.3.15 | A book used for time management | O | vegetarian |
| | | P | sending staff for training |

(15 × 1) (15)

**[50]**

**TOTAL SECTION A: 50**

## SECTION B

## QUESTION 2

2.1 As a receptionist on the Iqhayiya Campus in Port Elizabeth, part of your job is to accept delivery of goods at the reception desk. When a delivery is received, the receptionist has to complete the delivery register.

On 12 November 2019 at 13:00, you received a delivery from Mr Jacobs.

The following item was delivered to the company:

- 1 box of A4 typing paper, measuring 21,5 cm × 26 cm and weighing 10 kg; order number 0020; cost R180,00

The company paid by means of a cheque.

Complete the delivery register below by writing the answers in the ANSWER BOOK.

| Date | Time | Package size | Order number | Type of content | Amount | Name of sender | Name of receiver | Payment | Signature |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2.1.1 | 2.1.2 | 2.1.3 | 2.1.4 | 2.1.5 | 2.1.6 | 2.1.7 | 2.1.8 | 2.1.9 | 2.1.10 |

(10)

2.2 Read the scenario below and answer the questions.

The Iqhayiya Campus in Port Elizabeth has recently appointed a new group of office interns. Pumeza has volunteered to assist with the switchboard and other frontline duties at reception. She answers calls by saying 'Hello' and instead of transferring calls timeously, she spends too much time chatting to callers, blocking the lines for incoming calls. She also has a habit of chewing gum.

2.2.1 Why is chewing gum considered an unacceptable habit for frontline staff, also when answering the office telephone? (1)

2.2.2 Provide FOUR appropriate greetings/phrases Pumeza can use when answering the telephone. (4)

2.2.3 Explain THREE procedures that should be followed when transferring calls. (3)

2.2.4 Discuss the guidelines for booking or making calls. (7)

2.3 Name FIVE ways in which the receipt of visitors can be performed incorrectly. (5)

**[30]**

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## QUESTION 3

3.1 You work as a stock control clerk and have to make sure that ALL the information about each item is recorded on the stock card for that item. You have noted down the following:

(i) Business Practice NCV L4 Text books, Reference no. 06 Business Studies.

Sebokeng Campus: Mr Smith: 50 issued on 15 November 2019
Kempton Park Campus: Mrs Snail: 25 issued on 9 December 2019

(ii) Maximum level : 150
Minimum level : 20
Re-order level : 25
Textbooks received : 100 16 December 2019

(iii) On 2 January 2019 there were 100 books on the shelf.

Use the information given above to complete the stock record card.
Use the attached ANSWER SHEET (ADDENDUM A) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK. (15)

3.2 You work as a filing clerk at the Iqhayiya Campus in Port Elizabeth and one of your duties is to identify the files that are out at any time, with whom they are, and when they should be returned.

Use the following information to complete an index card for November 2019.
Use the attached ANSWER SHEET (ADDENDUM B) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK.

3.2.1 On 2 November 2019, Mrs Abraham from the Finance Department requested the monthly finance report file, ref no FS12. She returned it on 3 November 2019.

3.2.2 On 5 November 2019, Mr Small from the Office Administration Department requested the weekly minutes file, ref no OA13. He returned it on 8 November 2019.

3.2.3 On 10 November 2019, Mrs Nkomo from the Purchasing Department requested the requisition registration form file, ref no PU14. She returned it on 10 November 2019. (10)

3.3 Each organisation has particular policies and procedures in place for filing paper records. A continuous procedure for checking, tracking and securing records will result in a high standard of filing and service delivery. It will ensure that the correct records, with up-to-date information, are always available.

Briefly explain FIVE guidelines to follow to ensure that documents are securely filed at reception. (5)
**[30]**

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## QUESTION 4

4.1 You are asked to schedule a meeting with staff on the campus. The type of meeting you are arranging will determine what kind of venue is required.

4.1.1 What FIVE processes will be involved in selecting a venue?

4.1.2 Which FIVE factors should be taken into consideration when deciding on a suitable date for a meeting?

4.1.3 Name FIVE pieces of information you would send with a formal invitation to participants of a meeting.

(3 × 5) (15)

4.2 A personal assistant should constantly refer to his/her own diary, as well as the manager's diary.

Give FIVE reasons to refer to these diaries. (5 × 2) (10)

4.3 It is sometimes necessary to cancel an appointment or postpone it when something unexpected happens. As personal assistant to a dentist, Dr Khumalo, you are responsible for managing her diary. She has many bookings for the next two weeks. You need to prioritise a number of postponed appointments, to make sure that those with the highest priority get rescheduled soonest. Dr Khumalo may postpone a low-priority afternoon appointment, so that you can fit in a high-priority appointment.

Below are the bookings that you must postpone. Arrange these appointments according to HIGHEST, MEDIUM and LOWEST PRIORITY. Write only 'Highest', 'Medium' or 'Lowest priority' next to the question number (4.3.1–4.3.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

4.3.1 Mr Smith needs his dentures (false teeth) adjusted before he leaves to go overseas in a week.

4.3.2 Mrs Chauke has been up all night with toothache.

4.3.3 Eric Mabele of Bay Pharmaceuticals wants to explain a new range of products to Dr Khumalo.

4.3.4 Mr Martin has two cavities and he needs fillings.

4.3.5 Ann Nxobe needs a regular six-monthly check-up.

(5 × 1) (5)

**[30]**

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## QUESTION 5

Study the image below and answer the questions.




[Source: www.cartoonmotivators.com]

5.1 5.1.1 Identify THREE areas that are housekeeping concerns and describe the actions/duties that have to be performed to rectify them. (3 × 2) (6)

5.1.2 How would you describe the impact that the reception area in the image above would have on the reputation of the company? (2)

5.1.3 What THREE measures can be put in place to prevent the sub-standard situation pictured above from happening again? (3)

5.1.4 Identify FOUR areas above that compromise the safety and security of the environment. (4)

5.2 You work as a personal assistant to the campus manager at the Iqhayiya Campus in Port Elizabeth. Your duty is to make sure that both your diary and the campus manager's diary are effectively and efficiently recorded.

Indicate which of the items listed below must be entered into your diary and which must be recorded in the campus manager's diary.

Use the information below to complete both diaries for your campus.
Use the attached ANSWER SHEET (ADDENDUM C) and hand it in with your ANSWER BOOK.

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- Dates of the directors' board meetings
- Appointment with Mr Smith, the Human Resource Manager
- Attend a meeting to discuss a new project
- Fetch campus manager's children from school
- The college year-end function
- The booking of the auditorium
- The campus manager's trip to London to attend a conference
- Computer training for lecturers
- Invitation to deliver a speech at a seminar
- Printing of the campus report
- Review meetings with lecturers
- Attend an administrative staff meeting
- Read all e-mails and open post every day
- Book a flight to Botswana for the campus manager
- Present feedback report on a meeting (15)

**[30]**

**QUESTION 6**

The following cash transactions in the books of Trendsetters National took place during the month of August 2019.

Use ADDENDUM D (attached) to complete the petty cash journal for August 2019 and total ALL the columns.

Remember to hand in ADDENDUM D with the ANSWER BOOK.

| DAY | TRANSACTIONS |
|---|---|
| 06 | Purchased stamps from the post office, R27,50, voucher no. 001 |
| 08 | Bought an ink cartridge at Makro for R129,90 |
| 13 | Bought milk and tea from Spar, R54,90 |
| 15 | Sent a parcel via PostNet, R68,00 |
| 19 | Purchased a ream of printing paper from Game, R42,90 |
| 26 | Paid a casual worker, R100 |
| 28 | Gave R50 donation to a school competition |

**[30]**

**TOTAL SECTION B: 150**
**GRAND TOTAL: 200**

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**EXAMINATION NUMBER:** | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

**ADDENDUM A**

**QUESTION 3.1**

**STOCK CONTROL CARD**

**IQHAYIYA CAMPUS IN PORT ELIZABETH**

**STOCK CONTROL CARD**

**Item:……..** **Ref: ……..**

**Maximum: 150** **Minimum: 20** **Re-order: 25**

| Date | Receipts quantity | Quantity | Department staff member | Balance |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
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**ADDENDUM B**

**QUESTION 3.2**

**INDEX CARD**

**IQHAYIYA CAMPUS IN PORT ELIZABETH**

**INDEX CARD**

| Date issued | File ref | File name | Issued to name/department | Date returned |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
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**ADDENDUM C**

**QUESTION 5.2**

**DIARY**

| MANAGER'S DIARY | PERSONAL ASSISTANT'S DIARY |
|---|---|
| 1. | 1. |
| 2. | 2. |
| 3. | 3. |
| 4. | 4. |
| 5. | 5. |
| 6. | 6. |
| 7. | 7. |
| 8. | 8. |

(15)

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**EXAMINATION NUMBER:** | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

**ADDENDUM D**

**QUESTION 6**

**PETTY CASH JOURNAL OF TRENDSETTERS NATIONAL FOR AUGUST 2019**

| VOUCHER NO | DAY | DETAILS | PETTY CASH AMOUNT | STATIONERY | POSTAGE | WAGES | SUNDRIES ACCOUNT | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | | | Amount | Details |
| | | | | | | | | |
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